

SCHRODERS CLIENT GROUP INTERNSHIP 2027

Question Bank

Extracted from the complete interview pack. Source markers resolve to Part 15 of the full pack.

Likely Cappfinity video prompts (none confirmed as Schroders questions)

#	Prompt	Type	Tests	Scaffold (energy, evidence, learning, link)
1	Why are you interested in a career in asset management?	Motivation	Genuine, specific interest	Moment it clicked; what asset managers do for savers; why the client side; one current fact.
2	Why Schroders, and why Client Group rather than an investment team?	Motivation	Research and fit	Structure, economics, moment (Part 12); energy for client work.
3	What do you think a Sales intern in Client Group does day to day, and which part appeals most?	Motivation	Realistic job preview	Three real tasks ^[S7] ; the one you would enjoy and why; a time you did something similar.
4	Tell us about a recent market or economic event and how it might affect what our clients ask us.	Commercial	Event-to-client chain	Event, number, mechanism, which client, what they would ask, what you would do.
5	What have you done to learn about this industry, and what surprised you?	Motivation	Curiosity, initiative	Two concrete actions; one surprise with a number; how it changed your view.
6	Where do you see yourself in five years, and how would this internship help?	Motivation	Fit with the programme	Graduate programme, qualification, client seat; what you would learn here first.
7	What does a great day look like for you?	Strengths	Energisers	A real day; what made it great; the strength behind it; where Client Group offers that.
8	What energises you, and what drains you?	Strengths	Self-awareness, fit	Honest energiser linked to the role; honest drainer and how you manage it.
9	Tell us about something you learned recently purely because you were curious.	Strengths	Curiosity	What, why, how you went about it, what you did with it.
10	Do you prefer starting things or finishing them?	Strengths	Consistency and reasons	Pick one honestly; why; how you cover the other side.
11	Do you prefer the big picture or the detail?	Strengths	Consistency and reasons	Pick one; example; how you guard against the weakness.
12	What do you find easy that other people seem to find hard?	Strengths	Natural strengths	One thing; evidence others noticed; how it would help in sales.
13	What tasks tend to stay at the bottom of your to-do list?	Strengths	Honesty about drains	A real task; why; what system stops it slipping.
14	When have you felt most in your element?	Strengths	Energy	Scene, what you were doing, why it felt natural.
15	How would friends or teammates describe you, and would you agree?	Strengths	Self-awareness	Three words others use; one you agree with and one you'd nuance.

#	Prompt	Type	Tests	Scaffold (energy, evidence, learning, link)
16	What achievement are you most proud of, and why that one?	Strengths	Values	The achievement; why it mattered to you, not just the result.
17	Tell us about a time you built a relationship with someone very different from you.	Relationships	Rapport Builder	Energy line; how you found common ground; what it led to.
18	Describe a time you explained something complex to someone with no background in it.	Relationships	Explainer	Concept; your analogy; how you checked understanding.
19	Tell us about a time you changed someone's mind.	Relationships	Persuasion with integrity	Their view; your evidence; listening; the outcome; respecting their choice.
20	Tell us about a time you dealt with an unhappy customer or member of the public.	Relationships	Composure, client focus	Listen, acknowledge, act, follow up; what you learned.
21	How do you keep in touch with and maintain a network?	Relationships	Relationship Deepener	Your actual habit; an example where it paid off for both sides.
22	Tell us about a time you had several competing deadlines.	Organisation	Planful, Time Optimiser	The list; how you ranked; who you told; result.
23	Describe an event, project or society activity you coordinated. What would you do differently?	Organisation	Coordination	Scale in numbers; plan; problem; fix; the change next time.
24	Tell us about a setback and what you did next.	Resilience	Bounceback	What went wrong; first action; what you changed; later result.
25	When have you had to stay calm when things were going wrong?	Resilience	Centred	What was at stake; your method; the outcome.
26	Tell us about a time you took the initiative without being asked.	Drive	Self-starter	The gap; your first step; who you involved; result.
27	Tell us about feedback that changed how you work.	Growth	Coachability	Feedback; reaction; change; evidence.
28	Describe a time you contributed to a team's success. What was your role?	Teamwork	Collaboration	Team goal; your specific part; how you helped others.
29	Tell us about a time you used a creative approach to overcome a challenge.	Resourcefulness	Reported at Schroders [S290]	Constraint; idea; test; result.
30	How has your thinking changed over the past year about something that matters to you?	Growth	Official phrasing hint [S262]	Old view; what changed it; new view; what you do differently.

Likely work simulation scenarios, with a suggested ranking

S1. Client complaint email

RANK

SETUP	An IFA emails you: the Q3 factsheet for a fund they use is late and their client review is tomorrow. They are annoyed.
OPTIONS	A. Reply immediately with last quarter's factsheet so they have something. B. Acknowledge, apologise for the delay, check with the reporting team when the Q3 factsheet will be ready, and tell the IFA a time. Copy the relationship manager. C. Forward the email to the relationship manager and do nothing else. D. Reply saying factsheets are produced by another team and are not your responsibility.
BEST ORDER	B, C, A, D
WHY	B owns the client experience inside the rules. C is safe but slow. A sends out-of-date information that could mislead. D abandons the client.

S2. Three requests by 2pm

RANK

SETUP	It is 11am. RM1 wants a pitch book updated by 2pm for a final-round presentation. RM2 wants CRM notes from yesterday's meeting logged today. Your manager wants an event guest list by 5pm.
OPTIONS	A. Do them in the order they arrived. B. Start the pitch book, tell RM2 the notes will be done by 4pm, confirm the guest list for 5pm, and flag if the pitch book runs over. C. Ask your manager to choose the order for you before starting anything. D. Do the quick CRM notes first to clear your list, then the pitch book.
BEST ORDER	B, D, C, A
WHY	B ranks by deadline and stakes and manages expectations early. D is reasonable if the notes truly take minutes, but risks the fixed deadline. C is over-escalation for a clear call. A ignores stakes.

S3. The wrong number in the pack

RANK

SETUP	Twenty minutes before a client meeting you spot that a performance figure in the pack you built is for the wrong share class.
OPTIONS	A. Say nothing; the difference is small. B. Correct the slide yourself and reprint without telling anyone. C. Tell the RM immediately, give the correct approved figure and its source, and let them decide how to handle it in the meeting. D. Tell the RM after the meeting.
BEST ORDER	C, B, D, A
WHY	C is honest, fast and keeps the decision with the owner. B fixes the error but bypasses the record and approval. D lets the client see wrong data. A is misleading.

S4. Speaker drops out**RANK**

SETUP	The day before an adviser seminar with 40 guests, the fund manager speaker cancels.
OPTIONS	A. Cancel the event and email guests. B. Tell your manager now with two options: a named replacement from the same team, or a recorded update plus live Q&A. Draft the guest message for approval. C. Find a replacement yourself and tell your manager once it is sorted. D. Run the event with no change and hope guests don't mind.
BEST ORDER	B, C, A, D
WHY	B solves and escalates with options. C shows initiative but skips the owner. A is a last resort. D ignores the client experience.

S5. A client wants a view**RANK**

SETUP	On a volatile day, a family office client emails: "Should we sell our equity funds now?"
OPTIONS	A. Reply with your own view on whether to sell. B. Acknowledge, share the firm's latest published market commentary, and arrange a call with the RM and investment specialist. C. Tell them you can't discuss markets. D. Forward to the RM with no reply to the client.
BEST ORDER	B, D, C, A
WHY	B is helpful within the rules: published views, the right people, no personal advice. D is safe but leaves the client waiting. C is unhelpful. A risks unsuitable advice.

S6. Double-booked senior**RANK**

SETUP	Two senior RMs both booked the same fund manager for the same Thursday hour.
OPTIONS	A. Keep the first booking and tell the second RM. B. Lay out both requests with client, stage and deadline, and ask the person who owns the fund manager's diary to decide today. Offer alternative slots. C. Pick the one with the bigger client. D. Leave them to sort it out.
BEST ORDER	B, A, C, D
WHY	B makes the process fair and fast. A is a defensible rule but ignores stakes. C is you judging. D abdicates.

S7. Teammate not contributing**RANK**

SETUP	On an intern group project due Friday, one member has missed two check-ins.
OPTIONS	A. Do their part yourself. B. Message them privately, ask if something is wrong, agree a smaller piece they can deliver, and tell the group the plan. C. Report them to the programme manager straight away. D. Mention it in the final presentation.
BEST ORDER	B, A, C, D
WHY	B is fair, direct and keeps the team on track. A delivers but hides the problem. C escalates too early. D is public blame.

S8. CRM duplicates before a mail-out**RANK**

SETUP	Before a campaign email, you notice duplicate and out-of-date contacts in the list.
OPTIONS	A. Send anyway; duplicates are harmless. B. Flag it to the campaign owner, suggest a quick clean using agreed rules, and send once fixed. C. Delete records you think are wrong. D. Export the list to your laptop to fix it in Excel.
BEST ORDER	B, C, A, D
WHY	B protects data quality and the client experience. C is well meant but unilateral. A irritates clients. D takes personal data out of approved systems.

S9. Compliance-sensitive request**RANK**

SETUP	A client asks by email for this month's unpublished performance number and "any hot ideas".
OPTIONS	A. Send what you have; it's only a few days early. B. Explain politely that you can share published figures now and the month-end figure once released, and offer a call with the RM on market views. C. Ignore the email. D. Ask a colleague in the investment team for their ideas and pass them on.
BEST ORDER	B, C, D, A
WHY	B is courteous and inside the rules. C is poor service but no breach. D and A share unapproved information.

S10. A day-in-the-life video**RANK**

SETUP	You watch a short clip of a Schroders salesperson describing a day, then rate how much you would enjoy each task.
OPTIONS	Rate: client meetings; RFP writing; CRM updates; event logistics; market reading.
BEST ORDER	No right order
WHY	This tests consistency with Stage 2 and authenticity. Answer honestly. Say what energises you and show you know the dull parts exist.

A. Motivation: why this, why here, why now**Q1 Why asset management?**

TESTS Genuine interest versus a generic finance choice. **STRUCTURE** One moment you got interested; what the industry does for real people; why the client side.

WEAVE IN UK industry manages £10trn, half for overseas clients ^[S150]; retail now the largest client group ^[S150].

TRAP "I like markets" with no link to clients.

Q2 Why Schroders?

TESTS Mechanism, not adjectives; up to date on the deal. **STRUCTURE** Structure (central Client Group), economics (margin mix), moment (Nuveen). See Part 12.

WEAVE IN Client Group model ^[S72]; margins 6 to 57bp ^[S71]; Nuveen effective 1 Oct 2026 ^[S75].

TRAP "Prestigious family firm since 1804." Out of date this week.

Q3 Why Client Group rather than an investment team?

TESTS Whether you understand the client side is a career, not a consolation. **STRUCTURE** What energises you (explaining, relationships); what the three pillars do; one example of you doing it.

WEAVE IN Three pillars ^[S263]; Oomen's remit ^[S306].

TRAP Implying sales is a back-up for failing to get into investment.

Q4 Why sales specifically, rather than product or marketing?

TESTS Self-knowledge. **STRUCTURE** Name the activity you enjoy most (conversations, winning trust); acknowledge the others; show you know they are colleagues.

WEAVE IN Product, Marketing and Sales under one head ^[S306].

TRAP Dismissing the other teams.

Q5 What do you think a Sales intern here does day to day?

TESTS Realism. **STRUCTURE** Meeting packs, RFP and DDQ support, CRM, events, client requests, a project.

WEAVE IN Zurich Sales Activation posting ^[S7].

TRAP "Pitching to clients."

Q6 Where do you see yourself in five years?

TESTS Ambition that fits the programme. **STRUCTURE** Graduate programme, CFA Level 1, a client-facing seat, a specialism.

WEAVE IN Graduate programme and CFA support ^[S15].

TRAP A plan that leaves Schroders in year two.

Q7 Why now: what has changed at Schroders that makes this a good time?

TESTS Current awareness. **STRUCTURE** Client Group rebuilt 2025; Nuveen shelf; retail rule changes in 2027.

WEAVE IN ^[S72, S75, S168, S187].

TRAP Speculating about job cuts.

B. The firm**Q8 What do you know about Schroders' recent results?**

TESTS Whether you read primary sources. **STRUCTURE** One headline, one strength, one weakness, one so-what.

WEAVE IN H1 2026: AUM £867.8bn, profit +46%, net outflows £8.3bn incl. one £6.6bn mandate ^[S70].

TRAP Quoting outflows without the context.

Q9 What does the Nuveen deal mean for clients?

TESTS Calm, accurate messaging. **STRUCTURE** What stays (brand, London, CEO, standalone year); what grows (shelf); what to watch.

WEAVE IN ^[S76, S309].

TRAP Promising nothing will change, or guessing at integration.

Q10 How does Schroders make money?

TESTS Commercial basics. **STRUCTURE** Fee rate times assets, by business; costs; profit.

WEAVE IN NOR £2,504.3m; margins by business ^[S71].

TRAP Saying "commission" or "trading profits".

Q11 What are Schroders' three businesses?

TESTS Map of the firm. **STRUCTURE** Public Markets, Schroders Capital, Wealth Management; Client Group sells across them.

WEAVE IN ^[S71].

TRAP Forgetting wealth.

Q12 Who is Schroders' biggest competitor?

TESTS Judgement about competition. **STRUCTURE** Depends on channel: BlackRock/L&G in passive and DC; M&G, aberdeen, Jupiter in UK wholesale; private markets firms in alternatives.

WEAVE IN Part 4 table ^[S130 to S140].

TRAP One name with no reasoning.

Q13 What is one weakness at Schroders?**TESTS** Honesty without disloyalty. **STRUCTURE** Flows; context; what Client Group can do.**WEAVE IN** [S70, S71].**TRAP** Badmouthing or refusing to answer.**Q14 What are Schroders' values?****TESTS** Whether you read the annual report. **STRUCTURE** Excellence, innovation, teamwork, passion, integrity; one example of each you can show.**WEAVE IN** [S72].**TRAP** Leaving out teamwork.**C. Markets and the industry****Q15 Tell us about a market story you are following.****TESTS** Genuine interest and the event-to-client chain. **STRUCTURE** Event, number, mechanism, client, what you would watch.**WEAVE IN** BoE 3.75%, 3 votes to raise [S232]; Schroders house view [S242].**TRAP** A headline you can't explain two levels down.**Q16 What happens to bond prices when rates rise, and why?****TESTS** Basic finance. **STRUCTURE** Fixed coupon; new bonds pay more; old bond price falls until yields match.**WEAVE IN** 30-year gilts highest since 1998 [S237] **Reported**.**TRAP** Getting the direction wrong under pressure.**Q17 Active or passive: which would you choose for your own pension?****TESTS** A reasoned view. **STRUCTURE** Depends on asset class; low-cost core plus active where it adds value.**WEAVE IN** [S152, S319].**TRAP** Dogma either way.**Q18 What is the biggest risk to markets right now?****TESTS** Macro awareness. **STRUCTURE** Name one risk, its channel, what would show it's happening.**WEAVE IN** Long-term yields spike [S242]; concentration [S241].**TRAP** Listing five risks with no depth.**Q19 How would you explain inflation to a new client?****TESTS** Communication. **STRUCTURE** Plain words; one picture; what it does to their savings.**WEAVE IN** CPI 3.1% Aug 2026 [S232].**TRAP** Jargon.**Q20 What is a private market asset and why would a pension want one?****TESTS** Industry vocabulary. **STRUCTURE** Unlisted companies, loans, property; illiquidity premium; long horizon.**WEAVE IN** Mansion House 10% aim [S181].**TRAP** Ignoring liquidity risk [S196].**Q21 What is an ETF, and what is an active ETF?****TESTS** Product literacy. **STRUCTURE** Exchange-traded fund; active version has a manager; cheaper wrapper.**WEAVE IN** Schroders active ETFs \$4.3bn [S230].**TRAP** Saying ETFs are always passive.**Q22 What will the industry look like in five years?****TESTS** Structured thinking. **STRUCTURE** Pick one of four views; evidence; counter-view.**WEAVE IN** Part 5.7 [S154, S181, S196].**TRAP** Vague "technology will change everything".

D. The role and commercial sense

Q23 A client says our fees are too high. What do you say?

TESTS Value, not defensiveness. **STRUCTURE** Acknowledge; ask what they compare with; explain value; offer the published assessment of value; escalate pricing to the RM.

WEAVE IN Assessment of Value rules [S163, S164].

TRAP Offering a discount you can't authorise.

Q24 Why does a £6.6bn redemption hurt less than it sounds?

TESTS Margin thinking. **STRUCTURE** It was core solutions at about 6bp; revenue lost is about £4m a year.

WEAVE IN [S70, S71] **Inferred**.

TRAP Treating all assets as equal.

Q25 How would you prepare for a first meeting with a pension scheme?

TESTS Preparation and client empathy. **STRUCTURE** Public papers, size, liabilities, consultant, current managers, our relevant capabilities, one question to ask.

WEAVE IN 600+ UK pension clients [S27].

TRAP Leading with our products.

Q26 How would you measure whether a client event worked?

TESTS Data-driven Delivery thinking. **STRUCTURE** Attendance, follow-up meetings, pipeline, flows over a year; feedback.

WEAVE IN Salesforce campaign tracking [S7].

TRAP Counting attendees only.

Q27 What makes a good salesperson in asset management?

TESTS Values. **STRUCTURE** Listening, knowing the product and its limits, honesty, follow-through, patience over years.

WEAVE IN Client duration 4.6 years [S72].

TRAP "Being persuasive" alone.

Q28 How would you prioritise three urgent requests?

TESTS Organisation. **STRUCTURE** Deadline, consequence, owner; renegotiate out loud; confirm in writing.

WEAVE IN JD "manages expectations" [S263].

TRAP Doing them in the order received.

Q29 What rules would you need to know in your first week?

TESTS Compliance maturity. **STRUCTURE** Fair, clear, not misleading; approvals; professional vs retail; hospitality limits; inside information; data.

WEAVE IN [S401, S39, S40, S402, S403].

TRAP "Compliance handles that."

E. Competency and strengths (answer with energy, then evidence)

Q30 Tell us about a time you had to build a relationship with someone very different from you.

TESTS Rapport and relationship building. **STRUCTURE** Energy line; STAR; what you learned about them; link to clients.

WEAVE IN JD "trust-based relationships" [S263].

TRAP A story where you did all the talking.

Q31 Tell us about a time you explained something complex to a non-expert.

TESTS Explainer strength. **STRUCTURE** The concept; how you tested understanding; the result.

WEAVE IN JD "adapt style" [S263].

TRAP No check that they understood.

Q32 Describe a project or event you organised.

TESTS Planning, coordination. **STRUCTURE** Scale with numbers; your plan; a problem; how you fixed it.

WEAVE IN JD "event or project coordination" ^[S263].

TRAP Group achievement with no "I".

Q33 Tell us about a time you were under pressure.

TESTS Composure and method. **STRUCTURE** What was at stake; your method; the outcome; what you would repeat.

WEAVE IN JD "composure" ^[S263].

TRAP A story where pressure was self-inflicted and unresolved.

Q34 Tell us about something you started from scratch.

TESTS Self-starter. **STRUCTURE** The gap you saw; what you did first; who you brought in; result.

WEAVE IN JD "leading or launching projects" ^[S263].

TRAP Something you merely joined.

Q35 Tell us about a mistake you made.

TESTS Honesty and learning. **STRUCTURE** Real mistake; your part; fix; what changed after.

WEAVE IN Cappfinity values authentic reflection ^[S285].

TRAP A fake weakness.

Q36 Tell us about a time you disagreed with a teammate.

TESTS Collaboration. **STRUCTURE** Their view fairly stated; how you resolved it; the relationship after.

WEAVE IN AC group criteria: listen, collaborate ^[S262].

TRAP Winning the argument as the point.

Q37 What energises you, and what drains you?

TESTS Strengths fit. **STRUCTURE** Honest energiser linked to the role; a drainer you manage.

WEAVE IN Strengths Profile method ^[S283].

TRAP Saying nothing drains you.

Q38 Tell us about a time you used a creative approach to overcome a challenge.

TESTS Resourcefulness. Reported as asked at Schroders ^[S290]. **STRUCTURE** Constraint; your idea; result.

WEAVE IN ^[S290] **Reported**.

TRAP Creative but pointless.

Q39 Tell us about feedback that changed how you work.

TESTS Coachability. **STRUCTURE** Feedback; how you felt; what you changed; evidence it stuck.

WEAVE IN Buddy and training culture ^[S263].

TRAP Feedback you disagreed with and ignored.

F. Curveballs**Q40 Sell me this pen.**

TESTS Listening before pitching. **STRUCTURE** Ask what they need it for; match one feature to that need; close.

TRAP Listing features without questions.

Q41 What would you do if you finished your work early?

TESTS Initiative inside priorities. **STRUCTURE** Ask the team, read, offer help, tell your manager.

TRAP "Go home early."

Q42 What is something you believe that most people disagree with?

TESTS Independent thinking with reasons. **STRUCTURE** Claim, reason, number, counter.

WEAVE IN Part 8.

TRAP Something controversial and off-topic.

Q43 If you were CEO of Schroders tomorrow, what would you do first?

TESTS Strategic sense and humility. **STRUCTURE** Clients through the integration; flows in equities; one idea.

WEAVE IN [S70, S76].

TRAP A radical plan with no evidence.

Q44 What would you do if a client asked you for a stock tip?

TESTS Rules and courtesy. **STRUCTURE** Politely decline; explain you can share published views; refer to the RM.

WEAVE IN COBS 4; MAR [S401, S402].

TRAP Giving one.
